

Verses of Auspiciousness

Maṅgala Gāthā · Toh 826 · Derge Kangyur

བཀ་ཤིས་ཀྱི་གིས་སྤུཅད་པ།

The Verses of Auspiciousness (Sanskrit: Maṅgala Gāthā; Tibetan: Bkra shis kyi tshigs su bcad pa) is a short devotional text in verse that begins with a prostration to the Three Jewels. Its stanzas praise the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha in turn, presenting each as an auspicious source of peace for all beings. Verses of this kind are traditionally recited to invoke blessings, well-being, and good fortune at the start of an undertaking or on a festive occasion. The text is Toh 826 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section and is classed among the many brief liturgical and benedictory works preserved there.

May that holy one also bring well-being here and now. May the auspiciousness of the three families be complete.

In the language of India: Maṅgala Gāthā. In the language of Tibet: Verses of Auspiciousness.

I prostrate to the Three Jewels.

Endowed with every excellence, like a mountain of gold,
Protector of the three worlds, who has abandoned the three stains,
The Buddha, whose eyes are like the petals of an opened lotus:
May that auspiciousness be the first to bring peace to all beings.

Then the supreme, immovable teaching that He has shown,
Renowned throughout the three worlds and honored by gods and humans,
The holy Dharma that brings peace to all beings:
That is the second auspiciousness of this virtuous world.

The holy Saṅgha, rich in Dharma and in the auspiciousness of learning,
A field of offering for humans, gods, and asuras,
Supreme assembly, foundation of conscience and of glory:
That is the third auspiciousness of this virtuous world.

For the benefit of all sentient beings he held to awakening;
Disciplined, endowed with every means for accomplishing all aims,
Whatever auspiciousness arose for the Sage on the joyful path of
accumulation:

By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

For the benefit of beings the Tathāgata,
From the heart of the palace of the Joyous Land (Tuṣita) of the gods, came
here.

Whatever auspiciousness arose when he was encircled by Indra and the gods:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

In the beautiful Lumbinī grove, radiant with leaves and flowers,
When the Protector was born, attended by many gods,
Whatever auspiciousness arose, reaching the very end of existence:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

From the city of Kapilavastu, into the royal palace,
The Teacher, the Sugata, son of Śuddhodana, was born from the womb.
Whatever auspiciousness arose when he was sprinkled with the water of
nectar poured from a vase:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

In the holy city called Kapilavastu,
Praised aloud by the great and wondrous gods,
Whatever auspiciousness arose from the heap of merit of immeasurable
virtue:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Joyfully, in the middle of the night, he departed from the finest of cities
And went forth to the grove of austerities,
Whatever auspiciousness arose when Brahmā and the host of gods surrounded
him on every side:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Possessing a body radiant as gold,
Seated upon a spread of grass blue as beryl,
Legs crossed, immovable and supreme,
Whatever auspiciousness arose there:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

On the riverbank, filled with a garland of kuśa grass,
Dispelling, in a most wondrous way, the grip of existence,
Whatever auspiciousness arose when the king of the nāgas paid homage:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Seated at the foot of the king of trees, by the power of loving-kindness
He subdued the many hosts of the māras, on earth and in the sky.

Whatever diverse auspiciousness arose for the Blessed One:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

To destroy all suffering he sat on the seat of awakening,
And at the break of dawn subdued the four māras, the foes.
Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the Teacher, the Sugata:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

In the city of Vārāṇasī the supreme sage took his seat
And turned the supreme wheel of Dharma.
Whatever auspiciousness arose, most wondrous here and in the realm of the
gods:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Whatever auspiciousness brings benefit and works for the good,
Which noble beings, doers of merit, praise aloud,
Whatever the Blessed One, the lion of the Śākyas, declared:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Crushing the pride of all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
And to bring happiness to beings, the holy miracles...

Whatever auspiciousness there is of the Teacher, the Victor,
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Coming from the heavens to this world for the benefit of beings,
Surrounded on all sides by the host of gods, Brahmā and the rest,
Bearing in their hands drums, parasols, and banners of every kind,
Whatever auspiciousness there is in that:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

The Tathāgata, who has arrived at the supreme peace,
Honored before all with many mandārava flowers,
And praised aloud by the supreme gods,
Whatever auspiciousness there is in that:
By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Revered by the lord of the gods, by the nāgas, and by the sovereigns of
humankind,
Worshipped by the garuḍas, the yakṣas, and the lords of the gandharvas,
Whatever auspiciousness there is in the Tathāgata who possesses the ten
powers:

By that auspiciousness may all beings be at peace.

Here ends the verses of auspiciousness on the Three Jewels and the twelve deeds of the Buddha.

This was translated, revised, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra and the great editor-translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The passage is cut off mid-verse, and I have left the final line incomplete to match the source. The opening line is the tail of the preceding text, and "the three families" most likely refers to the three protectors (Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi), though this is not certain. In the verse about Kapilavastu, "the water of nectar poured from a vase" is a free reading of a compressed phrase, probably the gods' bathing of the newborn Bodhisattva. "Joyful path of accumulation" is a literal rendering of a difficult line, and the context may favor a more general sense of the accumulation of merit.
- The opening word "འོ་མ་ལྷ་མོ་" at the start of the passage appears to be a stray fragment and is not translated. The "ten powers" are the ten powers of a tathāgata (daśabala). The garuḍas are rendered from the Tibetan word for the sky-soaring bird (mkha' lding). The lord of the gods in the fourth stanza is Indra (Śakra), and the Brahmā of the second stanza is the creator-deity of the form realm. The twelve deeds are the traditional twelve acts of a buddha's life.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.